GROUP REPORTS

Skills Training, Nutrition, and Healthy Eating

Combined reports of Groups 3, 4, and 5

Group	Topic
3	**Introduction to Skills Training & Goal-Setting**
	Motor learning, SMART goals, and fundamental movement patterns
4	**What Are Nutrients?**
	Macronutrients, micronutrients, and recommended daily intake
5	**Healthy Eating Practices**
	Six essential nutrients, balanced diet, healthy habits, nutrition for fitness, and practical tips

GROUP 3

Introduction to Skills Training & Goal-Setting

Skills training in movement competency

Skills training in movement competency focuses on acquiring, refining, and mastering fundamental motor skills so they can be performed efficiently, safely, and without wasting energy.

Movement quality vs. quantity

Quality refers to **how well** a movement is performed (form, posture, and stability) rather than how fast it is done or how many repetitions are completed.

The three stages of motor learning

Stage	What happens
1. Cognitive Phase	The learner understands the goal and structure of the movement, often making frequent errors.
2. Associative Phase	Refining the movement, reducing errors, and building consistency.
3. Autonomous Phase	The movement becomes automatic, requiring less conscious attention.

Principles of goal-setting: the SMART goal framework

Letter	Meaning	Example (forearm plank)
S – Specific	Define a clear and detailed objective.	Forearm plank exercise
M – Measurable	Establish quantifiable metrics and data to track progress.	Hold for 60 seconds continuously
A – Achievable (Attainable)	Ensure the goal is realistic, doable, and matches your available skills and resources.	Increase current hold time by adding 10 seconds weekly
R – Relevant (Realistic)	Confirm that the goal matters.	Reduces lower back pain and builds full-body posture support
T – Time-bound (Timely)	Set a clear deadline.	Achieve within 4 weeks

Body movement patterns

Fundamental movements can be grouped into patterns. Learning each pattern with good form builds the base for almost every exercise and sport.

Lower body patterns

Pattern	Description
Squat	A compound movement where you lower your hips from a standing position by bending your knees and hips, keeping your torso upright, and then push back up.
Lunge	A single-leg movement where one leg steps forward, backward, or sideways, bending at the knee while the trailing leg lowers toward the floor.
Hinge	A movement where you bend forward by shifting your hips backward with a minimal bend in the knees, maintaining a flat, neutral spine.

Upper body patterns

Pattern	Description
Horizontal Push	Moving a weight or resistance directly away from your chest horizontally.
Horizontal Pull	Drawing a weight or resistance horizontally toward your chest or torso.
Vertical Push	Pressing a weight or resistance straight upward over your head, in line with your spine.
Vertical Pull	Pulling a resistance down toward your collarbone, or pulling your own body weight up vertically.

Object manipulation patterns

Pattern	Description
Lifting	The mechanics of safely picking up an object from the floor using your legs and hips while protecting your lower back.
Throwing	A powerful, rotational movement where you project an object away from your body using coordinated force from your legs, core, and arms.

GROUP 4

What Are Nutrients?

Nutrients are the essential substances in food that our bodies need to live, grow, and stay healthy. They are divided into two main categories:

- **Macronutrients (needed in large amounts):** carbohydrates, fats, and proteins. These provide the body with energy (calories) for daily work and growth.
- **Micronutrients (needed in small amounts):** vitamins and minerals, along with water. These do not give us energy, but they control body processes and keep us healthy.

The 6 essential nutrients and their functions

Macronutrients

Nutrient	Function	Types
1. Carbohydrates (Energy Provider)	Main energy source for our brain and physical activity.	**Simple carbs (sugars):** found in fruits and milk, but also added to sweets and sodas. **Complex carbs (starches and fiber):** found in oats, bread, and rice. Fiber helps digestion and keeps us full.
2. Fats (Stored Energy and Protection)	Gives concentrated energy (9 calories per gram) and helps absorb vitamins A, D, E, and K.	**Saturated fats:** found in meat and butter (should be limited). **Unsaturated fats:** healthy fats found in fish, nuts, and vegetable oils. **Trans fats:** processed fats in fried foods (should be avoided).
3. Proteins (Body Building Blocks)	Made of amino acids to build and repair muscles, tissues, and skin.	**Essential amino acids (9 types):** the body cannot make these, so we must get them from food. **Non-essential amino acids (11 types):** made naturally by the body.

Micronutrients and water

Nutrient	Function	Examples
4. Vitamins (Body Regulators)	Organic compounds needed in small amounts for immune health and growth.	Vitamin C for immunity, vitamin D for bone health, and vitamin A for eyesight.
5. Minerals (Structural Support)	Inorganic elements from the earth that support blood, bones, and fluid balance.	Calcium for strong bones, iron to carry oxygen in the blood, and sodium for fluid balance.
6. Water (Essential Fluid)	Zero calories, but carries nutrients to cells, flushes out waste, and keeps us hydrated.	Drinking water, plus fruits and vegetables with high water content.

Recommended daily intake (the target)

To maintain a balanced diet, here are the standard daily recommended amounts:

Nutrient	Recommended amount
Carbohydrates	45% to 65% of daily calories (about 225–325 grams)
Fats	20% to 35% of daily calories (about 44–77 grams)
Proteins	10% to 35% of daily calories (about 50–70 grams)
Water	9 cups a day for women, and 13 cups a day for men
Vitamins and minerals	Eat a wide variety of colorful fruits, vegetables, and whole foods every day to hit your daily targets naturally.

> **Key idea:** macronutrients fuel the body, while micronutrients and water regulate it. A balanced diet needs all six.

GROUP 5

Healthy Eating Practices

PART 1

Introduction: Healthy Eating Practices and Proper Nutrition

What are healthy eating practices?

Healthy eating practices refer to the habits of choosing, preparing, and eating a variety of nutritious foods in the right amounts to meet our body's needs. It means eating a balanced diet that provides the nutrients and energy necessary to keep our bodies healthy and functioning properly.

What is the importance of proper nutrition?

Proper nutrition is important because food provides the energy our bodies need for daily activities. It supports growth and development, strengthens our immune system, helps repair body tissues, and maintains our overall health. As students, proper nutrition can also help us stay energized and focused during our classes and activities.

What is the relationship between healthy eating and physical fitness?

Healthy eating and physical fitness work together. Exercise helps strengthen our muscles and improve our endurance, while proper nutrition provides the energy and nutrients our bodies need to perform physical activities and recover afterward.

For example, carbohydrates provide energy for activities like running and playing sports, while protein helps repair and maintain our muscles. Drinking enough water also helps prevent dehydration, especially when we sweat during exercise.

> **To summarize:** healthy eating is not just about satisfying our hunger; it is about giving our bodies the proper nutrients they need to stay healthy, active, and strong.

PART 2

The Six Essential Nutrients

Our bodies need six types of nutrients to work well. We need some of them in large amounts (carbohydrates, proteins, fats, and water) and others in smaller amounts (vitamins and minerals), but all six are important. No single food contains all of them, which is why we need to eat a variety of foods every day.

Nutrient	What it does for the body	Common food sources
1. Carbohydrates	The body's main source of energy. They help us perform daily activities and exercise.	Rice, corn, bread, oatmeal, camote, potato, cassava, saging
2. Proteins	Help build and repair muscles, tissues, and other body parts. They are important for growth.	Fish, chicken, lean meat, eggs, tofu, monggo and other beans, milk
3. Fats	Provide stored energy, protect organs, keep the body warm, and help absorb vitamins.	Fish, nuts, avocado, eggs, vegetable oils (use in small amounts)
4. Vitamins	Help the body function properly, support the immune system, and maintain healthy skin, eyes, and bones.	Fruits, vegetables, malunggay, carrots, mango, papaya, citrus fruits
5. Minerals	Help build strong bones and teeth, support nerve function, and help carry oxygen throughout the body.	Milk, small fish, leafy greens, beans, liver, eggs, seafood
6. Water	Keeps the body hydrated, regulates body temperature, and helps transport nutrients and remove waste.	Drinking water, plus fruits and vegetables with high water content

Remember: carbohydrates, proteins, and fats are called macronutrients because the body needs them in larger amounts. Vitamins and minerals are micronutrients. They are needed in tiny amounts but are essential for health.

PART 3

Balanced Diet and Proper Food Choices

What is a balanced diet?

A balanced diet is an eating pattern that includes the right kinds and amounts of food from all the major food groups, so the body gets all the nutrients it needs without too much or too little of anything. Balance, variety, and moderation are the three keys: eat foods from different groups, choose different foods within each group, and avoid going overboard on any one food.

The importance of fruits and vegetables

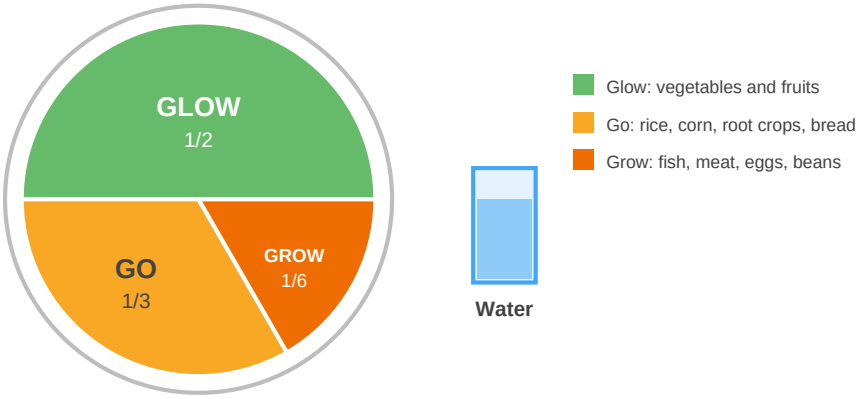
Fruits and vegetables are rich in vitamins, minerals, fiber, and water, and they are low in calories. Fiber keeps digestion regular and helps us feel full, while vitamins and minerals protect the body against illness. Eating a variety of colors (green leafy vegetables, orange carrots and squash, red tomatoes, yellow fruits) helps us get different nutrients.

Choosing whole grains and healthy protein sources

- **Whole grains** such as brown rice, corn, oatmeal, and whole wheat bread keep more fiber and minerals than highly refined grains, and they give longer-lasting energy.
- **Healthy proteins** include fish, chicken without the skin, eggs, tofu, and legumes such as monggo and beans. These give protein with less unhealthy fat than fatty or heavily processed meats.

Applying the Pinggang Pinoy food guide

Pinggang Pinoy (“Filipino Plate”) is a food guide developed by the Department of Science and Technology–Food and Nutrition Research Institute (DOST-FNRI) together with the Department of Health. It uses a plate to show the right proportion of the three food groups in each meal. For adults, half of the plate is for **Glow** foods (vegetables and fruits, with more vegetables than fruits), about one-third is for **Go** foods (energy-giving foods like rice, corn, bread, and root crops), and about one-sixth is for **Grow** foods (body-building foods like fish, meat, eggs, and beans). A glass of water goes beside the plate.



Pinggang Pinoy for adults. Versions for children, teens, and other groups have slightly different proportions.

> **How to apply it:** before you eat, look at your plate. Is half of it vegetables and fruits? Is there a source of protein? Is the rice portion reasonable? If yes, your meal is on track.

PART 4

Healthy Eating Habits

Good nutrition is built on daily habits. Here are four important habits that help us eat healthily.

1. Eating regular, balanced meals

Eat meals regularly and include different nutritious foods such as vegetables, fruits, protein, and carbohydrates. Skipping meals often leads to extreme hunger and poor food choices later in the day.

2. Eating breakfast when appropriate

Breakfast can provide energy and nutrients that help us start our day. For students, a good breakfast supports concentration and energy during morning classes.

3. Practicing portion awareness

Eat the right amount of food based on your body's needs and activity level. A very active person needs more food than someone who sits most of the day, and larger servings are not always better.

4. Eating slowly and recognizing hunger and fullness

Eat slowly, pay attention to your body's signals, and stop when you feel comfortably full. It takes time for the brain to realize that the stomach is full, so eating too fast can lead to overeating.

> **Quick check:** Regular meals, breakfast, right portions, slow eating. Practice these four habits every day and they will become automatic.

PART 5

Foods and Drinks to Limit

Some foods and drinks are fine once in a while but harmful when eaten too often or in large amounts. The goal is to **limit** them, not necessarily to ban them completely.

Limit this	Examples	Why it matters
Foods high in added sugar	Candies, cakes, ice cream, etc.	Too much sugar can lead to tooth decay, weight gain, and a higher risk of diabetes.
Excessive salt and sodium	Instant noodles, chips, canned meat, etc.	Too much sodium can raise blood pressure over time.
Frequently eating highly processed foods	Processed meat, burgers, fries, etc.	They are often high in salt, unhealthy fats, and calories but low in fiber and vitamins.
Sugary drinks and excessive caffeine	Soft drinks, milk tea, coffee, strong tea, etc.	Sugary drinks add many calories without nutrients, and too much caffeine can disturb sleep.

Smarter swaps

Instead of...	Try...
Soft drinks and milk tea	Water, buko juice with no added sugar, or a smaller, less sweet serving
Chips and instant noodles as a snack	Boiled saging or camote, fruit, or unsalted nuts
Burgers and fries	Grilled or boiled fish or chicken with rice and vegetables
Cakes and candy every day	Fresh fruit, and save sweets for special occasions

PART 6

Healthy Eating for Physical Fitness

How food provides energy for physical activities

Food is the body's fuel. During exercise the body mostly uses carbohydrates for quick energy, with fats supplying energy for longer, lighter activity. Eating foods such as rice, bread, oatmeal, or fruit a few hours before sports gives the body the fuel it needs to run, play, and train without running out of energy.

Nutrition for muscle growth and recovery

When we exercise, our muscles undergo small amounts of wear and tear. Protein helps repair and rebuild them so they become stronger, and carbohydrates refill the energy stores used during activity. Good choices after exercise include eggs, fish, chicken, milk, tofu, or beans with some rice or bread. Vitamins and minerals from fruits and vegetables also support recovery. Getting enough rest and sleep is part of recovery too.

Importance of hydration before, during, and after exercise

- **Before:** drink water in the hours before exercise so you start well hydrated.
- **During:** take small sips regularly, especially in hot weather or long activity, because we lose water through sweat.
- **After:** drink water to replace what was lost. Dehydration can cause tiredness, headaches, dizziness, and cramps.

Eating a variety of foods to support an active lifestyle

No single food can supply everything an active body needs. Eating a variety of foods from all food groups ensures we get enough energy, protein, vitamins, and minerals to stay strong, prevent illness, and keep up with our activities. The Pinggang Pinoy plate is also a good guide for active people, who may simply need larger portions.

> **Fitness formula:** Carbohydrates for energy + protein for repair + water for hydration + a variety of fruits and vegetables for vitamins and minerals.

PART 7

More Healthy Eating Habits: Water, Legumes, and Fresh Foods

Beyond the basic habits in Part 4, these additional practices round out a healthy way of eating.

Drink enough water

Water is essential for nearly every body function: it keeps us hydrated, regulates body temperature, and helps carry nutrients and remove waste. A common guideline is about eight glasses a day, and more when the weather is hot or we are physically active. Make water your main drink instead of soft drinks and other sugary beverages.

Eat more legumes

Legumes such as monggo, beans, chickpeas, and peas are affordable sources of plant protein and fiber, and they also supply minerals such as iron. They are easy to find in Philippine markets and can be cooked as ginisang monggo, added to soups, or used in place of meat in some meals. They are one of the best budget-friendly choices for healthy eating.

Choose fresh and minimally processed foods

Whenever possible, choose fresh vegetables, fruits, fish, and whole grains over heavily processed alternatives. When cooking, prefer boiling, steaming, grilling, or sauteing with a little oil over deep frying, and go easy on salt, soy sauce, and seasoning powders.

> **Tip:** Fill half your plate with vegetables, add a serving of legumes or fish, and keep a glass of water beside you. It is simple, affordable, and healthy.

PART 8

Practical Tips, Conclusion, and Call to Action

Affordable healthy food choices for students

Healthy eating does not have to be expensive. Many of the most nutritious foods are also the cheapest:

- **Vegetables:** malunggay, kangkong, pechay, kalabasa, sitaw, and other local, in-season vegetables.
- **Protein:** eggs, monggo and other legumes, tofu (tokwa), and affordable local fish.
- **Energy foods:** rice (brown or mixed when possible), camote, saging, and corn.
- **Fruits:** bananas, papaya, and other seasonal fruits from the local market.
- **Drinks:** plain water from home in a reusable bottle costs far less than soft drinks or milk tea.

Simple meal-planning tips

- Plan a few meals ahead for the week and make a short shopping list so you buy only what you need.
- Cook in batches and reuse ingredients. For example, extra vegetables can go into tomorrow’s soup.
- Use Pinggang Pinoy as your checklist: half vegetables and fruits, a bit of protein, a portion of rice.
- Prepare snacks and a water bottle ahead of time so you are not tempted to buy junk food.
- Shop at the local market for fresh, seasonal produce, which is usually cheaper.

Building sustainable eating habits

Healthy eating is a lifelong practice, not a short-term diet. Start with small changes, such as adding one vegetable to lunch or replacing one sugary drink with water each day, and build from there. Do not aim for perfection: enjoying a favorite treat once in a while is fine as long as your everyday habits are healthy. Consistency matters more than strictness.

Summary of the report

This report discussed that healthy eating means choosing a variety of nutritious foods in the right amounts. We learned about the six essential nutrients (carbohydrates, proteins, fats, vitamins, minerals, and water) and how each supports the body. A balanced diet, guided by Pinggang Pinoy, includes plenty of fruits and vegetables, whole grains, and healthy proteins. Good habits such as eating regular meals, having breakfast, watching portions, and eating slowly help us eat well, while limiting sugar, salt, processed foods, and sugary or highly caffeinated drinks protects our health. Finally, proper nutrition and hydration fuel physical activity and help the body recover.

Closing message

Our food choices today shape our health, energy, and success tomorrow. As students, we have the power to start building healthy habits now, and those habits can last a lifetime.

Call to action: Starting today, fill half your plate with vegetables and fruits, drink more water, and choose healthier snacks. Share what you learned with your family and friends so that together we can build a healthier community. Small changes, practiced every day, make a big difference.

Reference

Food and Nutrition Research Institute, Department of Science and Technology (DOST-FNRI). *Pinggang Pinoy food guide.* fnri.dost.gov.ph